

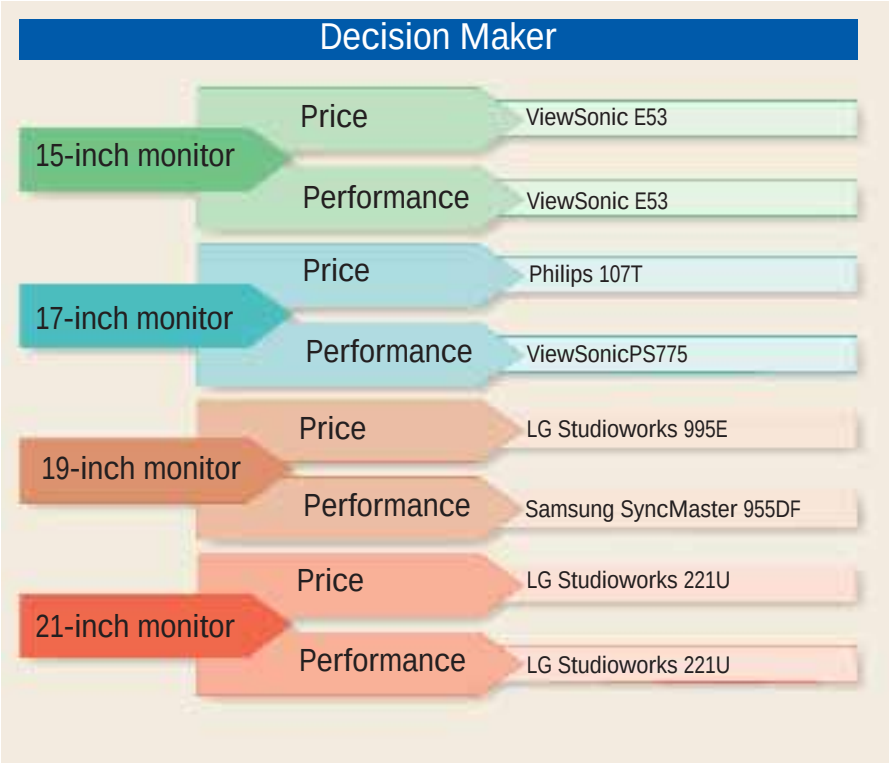
Warranty

We expect our monitors to last a lifetime and most of us ignore the warranty clause. But it doesn't hurt to have a monitor that has more warranty period. The Microtek 1569MD and Microtek Flavision 38FI came with an impressive three-year onsite warranty. This was the shining spot for these monitors, which otherwise showed an unsatisfactory performance.

On the other hand, major players such as Acer, Compaq, HP and Samsung came with only a one-year warranty. Ideally, the monitor should have a two-year warranty. HP-P920, LG Studioworks 995E (both 19-inch) and the 21-inch LG Studioworks 221U sported a three year warranty. This spells as peace of mind given the price that you might shell out for these monitors.

CONCLUSION

The competition was really fierce in the 15-inch category with not much in terms of features or performance to distinguish between the winner, first runner-up and



ViewSonic E53 (15-inch): an all rounder



Samsung Syncmaster 955DF (19-inch): where performance is the key



LG Studioworks 995E (19-inch): great value



LG Studioworks 221U (21-inch): a clear winner

second runner-up. The **ViewSonic E53** emerged as the winner over the Sony CPD-E100 by a mere 0.22 per cent. Although, Sony performed better, its high price due to the Aperture Grille CRT and lesser warranty of just one year made it lose out to the ViewSonic. The ViewSonic E53 also emerges the best buy for the value conscious.

In the 19-inch category, the **Samsung SyncMaster 955DF** came out tops for many reasons. The monitor was lighter, had a USB hub and even though the price was not the lowest at Rs 32,000, given its performance, the price seems justified. The second in this category was the Acer P911, which again scored higher in the performance test than the Samsung SyncMaster 955DF but lost due to its lower bandwidth, higher price and heavyweight nature. If you are value-conscious, then you might want to try out the **LG Studioworks 995E**.

In the 21-inch category, there was no problem identifying **LG Studioworks** as the clear winner. While both the monitors scored equally well in the feature tests, the LG monitor took the lead by upping its performance, especially in the geometry distortion, colour and gray scale tests. The LG also had one upstream and four downstream USB ports that added to the use of the monitor for different purposes. ■